Jake Walder

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Senior Game Designer with a decade in games and **15+ titles** across mobile, PC and console, played by **over 170 million players**. Experience ranges from leading design and production to developing, scoring and shipping independent titles in Unity. A positive and dedicated problem-solver with a player-first mindset, focused on making every game great to play.

Projects: Showreel · Penguin Slide · Woodoku · Meathook · The Adventure Pals

INDEPENDENT & FREELANCE WORK

Walder Games — *Independent Game Developer* Feb 2026 - Present

- Designed, developed and released *Penguin Slide* on Itch.io independently, from first prototype to launch, creating all code, art, music, SFX and levels in Unity and using AI to accelerate development.
- Developing a vertical slice of puzzle-adventure title *Godmother* in Unity, designing gameplay, writing narrative and creating art, music and SFX.

Design Consultant & Composer — *MEATHOOK, Indie Title* Feb 2025 - July 2026

- Conducted a full game audit and design consultation, improving core mechanics and systems, tutorial and progression flow, level design and UI/UX design.
- Co-wrote, produced, mixed and mastered the soundtrack for *Meathook* under the alias HYPNO.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Game Designer — *Tripledot Studios, London* Sept 2022 - Feb 2026

Design lead for Woodoku (150M+ downloads) and Woodoku Blast (20M+), owning the full player experience from core gameplay to live content, reporting directly to the CPO and Level Design Director.

- Raised *Woodoku* engagement by 20% and ARPDAU by 15% by redesigning the steep difficulty curve with a gentler ramp and small spikes, keeping players challenged without frustrating them into churning.
- Increased *Woodoku Blast* ARPDAU by over 10% by designing and producing new features, mechanics and LiveOps events, while also raising D30 retention by 5% through A/B-tested level iterations.
- Lifted *Woodoku* D30 retention by 5% by engineering new shape-generation algorithms, while creating and optimising 152 levels a week for LiveOps.
- Cut level production time by 50% by designing a visual level editor to replace hand-edited JSON files: a paintbrush-and-palette workflow with instant in-editor playtesting, also improving quality and variety.
- Owned design across gameplay, systems, UX, haptics and audio for *Woodoku* and *Woodoku Blast*.
- Directed production of all owned features from ideation to post-release, with the final say on scope and direction, working directly with Product, Engineering, Art and QA.
- Co-owned the roadmap with the Product Manager, pitching new features and plans to stakeholders.
- Led a 3-person design team, mentoring two designers through promotions (Junior → Senior, Junior → Mid), and completed an 8-module management programme.
- Organised and ran playtests and brainstorms, and consulted on new game projects across the studio.

Game Designer — *Playtika, London* June 2020 - June 2022

Sole Game Designer on BRIX Blast Friends and BRIX Blast Rivals, reporting directly to the Product Lead, owning all design and documentation and representing the player in product decisions.

- Designed and curated dozens of features, managing their development from the initial idea to final implementation by writing detailed specs and directing the work of the developers and artists.
- Solely responsible for level design on both titles, using player data to iterate on levels and improve retention, engagement and monetisation.

QA Lead & Level Designer — *Massive Monster, Southampton* Oct 2015 - Aug 2016

> ***'Your dedication, attitude and all round personality have made you a joy to work with.' – Jay Armstrong, Co-Founder***

- Designed and curated over 50% of the levels and designed various mechanics for *The Adventure Pals*, designed the hardest levels for *Never Give Up*, and curated and edited a large set of external levels.
- Responsible for all QA and level curation for both titles, ensuring polished levels and game stability.

QA Tester (Part-Time) — *Excalibur Publishing, Banbury* Oct 2015 - Aug 2016

- Responsible for QA of over 10 Steam titles, including *Jalopy* and *Shoppe Keep*, which required a strong grasp of gameplay mechanics to effectively identify, analyse and document bugs.

MUSIC

HYPNO — Electronic Music Duo June 2020 - Present

- Co-wrote, produced and mixed 3 singles released across all major music platforms and aired on BBC Introducing; created custom single artwork using Photoshop.

EDUCATION

Bournemouth University — *BSc Games Programming (2:1)* Sept 2016 - June 2019

- Completed a research dissertation involving a reaction-time-based mobile game in Unity (75%) and developed core skills through modules in Gameplay, Physics, UI, Core Loops and AI.

Peter Symonds College — *Maths, Physics & Computing A-Levels* Sept 2013 - June 2015

SKILLS

- **Gameplay Design**, **Level Design**, **Systems Design**, UI/UX, LiveOps, Balancing & Economy, **Wireframing**, Tools, QA Systems.
- **Unity**, **Photoshop**, Looker, Figma, Miro, VSCode, **Aseprite**, **Excel/Sheets**, GitHub, JIRA, Confluence, **Claude**, Antigravity, Blender.
- Experienced with **C#**, **C++** and **SQL** and utilising **AI tools** to visualise concepts, accelerate development and create rapid prototypes.

INTERESTS

- **Music:** Guitarist, self-taught music producer currently writing and producing 2 albums. Previously recorded with a Grammy-winning producer, aired by BBC Introducing and performed at a music festival.
- **Travelling:** Recently took an intentional career break to travel all over Southeast Asia for 6 months.
- **Games:** Constantly playing and staying up to date with the console, PC and mobile markets.
- **Hardware & Audio:** Utilise self-taught electronics knowledge to modify guitars and create guitar pedals.